MUSIC

KEY NOTES

With his upcoming EP, Canadian-Punjabi music producer **Gminxr** is getting ready to face the spotlight



"I thought, maybe people have forgotten me," says Gminxr, about his appearance at the Mumbai leg of the multi-city Zomaland festival in February this year. "But I was definitely wrong. They have not, and they're excited for what's next." The Canadian-Punjabi music producer tells INDIA TODAY exactly what's next: his debut EP *Hit List*, which will be released this month by Warner Music's South Asian music-focused sub-label 91 North Records.

The five-song *Hit List*, a collaborative effort made with singer and rapper Tegi Pannu and the pop duo Zehr Vibe, is the first collection as a lead artist from Gminxr, who is best known as the beatmaker behind A.P. Dhillon, Gurinder Gill and Shinda Kahlon's breakthrough hits 'Brown Munde' and 'Insane'. Much like his work with Dhillon and his former crew, Gminxr's tunes on *Hit List* are infused with elements of R&B and hip-hop, with the Afrobeats-influenced 'Celine' likely to be a favourite. He made the track especially for fans in Mumbai, which he believes is a "rhythm city" where the crowds are "a little louder and the stage shakes a little bit more".

While he thrives on the energy of the audience—like he did at Zomaland—Gminxr has mostly stayed away from the spotlight, not even revealing his real name, Gagundeep Singh Randhawa, until recently. He adopted the moniker Gminxr because the majority of his hits are in the key of G minor.

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SINGING FROM EXPERIENCE

Singer-songwriter Ditty's second solo album—*KALI*—covers themes with contemporary relevance



The personal is never far from the political in the music of folk singer/ songwriter Ditty. "My experiences are a starting point to speak about larger issues," says the Delhi-raised, Berlin-based artist whose recently released second solo album *KALI* covers themes such as colourism ("Kali"), consumerism ("Money"), ecological conservation ("Azadi") and global conflict ("Duniya").

"I really enjoy singing about topics like capitalism or the climate because they are things you can't always speak about and have conversations about," says Ditty, among the handful of Indian musicians to have staged carbon-neutral tours. In 2021, she put out the album *Rain Is Coming* as part of the trio Faraway Friends, a project that emerged out of her work with the German water rights NGO Viva con Agua.